



Awakening Eden

Begin

Interbeing

Principles

Soil

Abundance

Welcome home, fellow gardener

LIVING COMPANION NO. 01

Awakening Regeneration

The guide we wish someone had given us before we planted our first garden.

A heart-centred beginning into living soil, syntropic thinking, food forests, regenerative interbeing and practical ways to help life flourish.



WELCOME TO AWAKENING EDEN

Start reading

Open the first doorway

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A Living Library for Regeneration, Learning

You're here. This is more than a welcome to a community and a journey of remembering, holistic well-being, deep nature connection, a regenerative path of creating a more beautiful world.

Be as you are.

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How to use this Living Companion

Do not rush. This is not a test. This is an invitation to begin a relationship with life.

1

Read one chapter.

Let one idea land before gathering more information.

2

Try one action.

Cover a patch of soil, observe the sun, plant one herb, start one compost bowl.

3

Notice what changes.

Regeneration begins when attention becomes relationship.

Come walk with us

Nature never hurries. Yet everything grows.

Find your why

Before asking what to plant, ask why you want to regenerate.

Perhaps you are worried about the future. Perhaps your heart hurts when you see degraded land, lonely communities or food systems that no longer nourish life. Perhaps you simply know that another way of living is possible.

Purpose grows deeper roots than motivation. When your why is clear, small actions become part of something much larger.



One action today

Sit outside for ten minutes. Ask: **What kind of world do I want my daily actions to feed?**

THE DEEPER THREAD Regenerative interbeing

Regenerative interbeing is our way of describing the lived experience that our wellbeing is inseparable from the wellbeing of the living world.

Feeling the oneness without burning out

Many regenerators feel deeply. We may feel the cries of forests, oceans, animals and communities. That sensitivity is a gift — but only

Healthy soil supports healthy plants. Healthy plants support insects, birds, animals and people. Communities flourish through trust, generosity and shared care. In the same way, our inner lives and our outer actions continuously shape one another.

For Benjy, this became real through meditation, time in forests, documentaries that opened the heart, tree planting, ocean encounters, yoga, community and the felt sense that life is one great web of relationships.

Regeneration is not only restoring landscapes. It is restoring relationship: with ourselves, each other, food, water, soil, community and future generations.

when held with boundaries, rest, joy and support.

Regeneration includes the regenerators. Rest is not leaving the work. Rest is how the work becomes sustainable.

THE LIVING PRINCIPLES

What nature keeps teaching

Diversity creates resilience

Companion planting, beneficial species, flowers, herbs, fungi, insects and trees all

Cover the soil

Mulch is the soil's blanket, armour and food source. Bare soil is vulnerable soil.

Disturb less, feed more

Instead of constant tilling, feed life from above with compost, leaves, wood chips,

strengthen the living system.

manure and chop-and-drop biomass.

Design with sun and water

Observe morning sun, afternoon heat, slope, contour, runoff, shade and wind before planting.

Think in layers

Food forests grow in strata: canopy, understory, shrubs, herbs, roots, groundcovers, climbers and fungi.

Work with succession

Pioneers prepare the way. Fast species create shade and biomass. Long-lived trees inherit the future.

Living soil is the foundation

Soil is not dirt. Soil is a living community.

Healthy soil holds water, cycles nutrients, stores carbon, supports roots, feeds microorganisms and becomes the quiet foundation for resilient landscapes. The fastest way to begin is not by buying many products, but by protecting the soil and feeding biology.

- Keep soil covered with mulch, leaves, straw, wood chips or living plants.
- Add compost and organic matter regularly.
- Plant living roots as much of the year as possible.
- Reduce unnecessary disturbance.
- Invite fungi with wood, perennial plants and patience.

One action today

Find one patch of bare soil and cover it with organic matter.

Quick start: regenerate one corner

Observe

Where does water flow?
Where is the shade?
Which plants already thrive? What does the land show you after rain?

Feed

Layer leaves, compost, woody material, manure where appropriate, green cuttings and mulch to build a living sponge.

Plant

Start with diversity: support species, herbs, flowers, groundcovers, shrubs and trees that suit your climate.

Benjy's Abundant Edge Method

Edges are where life gathers. Water slows. Roots meet. Biomass collects. Fungi spread. Diversity increases.

The Abundant Edge method is Benjy's evolving way of building fertile planting lines and tree connections using locally available materials: wood, charcoal or charged biochar where available, compost, manure, green

Basic pattern

1. Observe contour and water movement.
2. Create a shallow trench or edge where appropriate.
3. Add woody material and organic matter.
4. Use charged biochar thoughtfully if available.

cuttings, mulch and water-holding trenches or raised edges.

The purpose is simple: create a moist, biologically active sponge around plants so young systems can establish in challenging climates.

5. Plant diversity into and around the edge.

6. Mulch heavily and keep feeding with chop-and-drop.

Syntropic thinking

Syntropy invites us to design with life's tendency to build increasing complexity, cooperation and abundance over time.

In syntropic farming, plants are arranged through time and space. Fast-growing species create biomass, shade and protection. Pruning stimulates growth. Chop-and-drop feeds the soil. Succession guides the system from pioneers toward abundance.

The lesson is bigger than farming: life flourishes when each part supports the greater whole.

One action today

Plant one fast-growing support species near a slower long-term plant, and plan how future pruning can feed the soil.

Mediterranean regeneration

Mediterranean climates ask for special care: wet winters, dry summers, strong sun, fire risk and fragile water cycles. Regeneration here begins with shade, mulch, organic matter, water harvesting, wind protection and species that can handle seasonal stress.

- Plant in the cooler, wetter season where possible.
- Mulch deeply before summer heat.
- Use support species for shade and biomass.
- Create fire-aware zones and reduce dry fuel near homes.
- Prioritise water infiltration over runoff.

Come walk with us

Remember: the goal is not to force a rainforest into every place. The goal is to help each landscape become more alive in its own way.

Before you go...

Take one slow breath. Step outside if you can. Notice one living being. Plant one seed. Smile at someone. Drink some water. Rest when you need to.

Life grows through small acts of care.

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Continue to Step Two

Thriving in These Times

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Every forest began as one small seed.

May your inner garden flourish. May the gardens you create nourish others.

May we leave this Earth, together, a little more alive than we found it.

With love, Benjy & Sofia · Awakening Eden